

EXCLUSIVE

IAS PRELIMS 2026

CURRENT AFFAIRS

REVISION

GS-1 (DYNAMIC)

MODULE - 19



**POLITY & OTHER
NATIONAL
EVENTS - 3**



- It is the first project under the **National Perspective Plan** for interlinking of rivers.
- It envisages transferring **water** from the **Ken** river to the **Betwa** river, both are the tributaries of **Yamuna**.
- It involves deforesting a portion of Panna Tiger Reserve in Madhya Pradesh.
- **Daudhan dam** to be built on the **Ken** river.
- The project lies in the **Bundelkhand** region.
- In addition to Panna, three wildlife sanctuaries i.e., **Nauradehi**, **Rani Durgavati** of Madhya Pradesh and **Ranipur** of UP are planned to be integrated with **Panna Tiger Reserve** for proper conservation of wildlife under the tiger reserve.

KNOW THE FEATURES OF INDIA-MYANMAR BORDER



It is situated in Black Sea. It came under Russian control when Crimea was annexed by Russia in 2014. Kerch Strait connects Black Sea with Sea of Azov.

SEVASTOPOL PORT

It is in Azerbaijan and situated in Caspian Sea and one of the key ports for International North-South Transport Corridor (INSTC).

PORT OF BAKU

CHABAHAH PORT

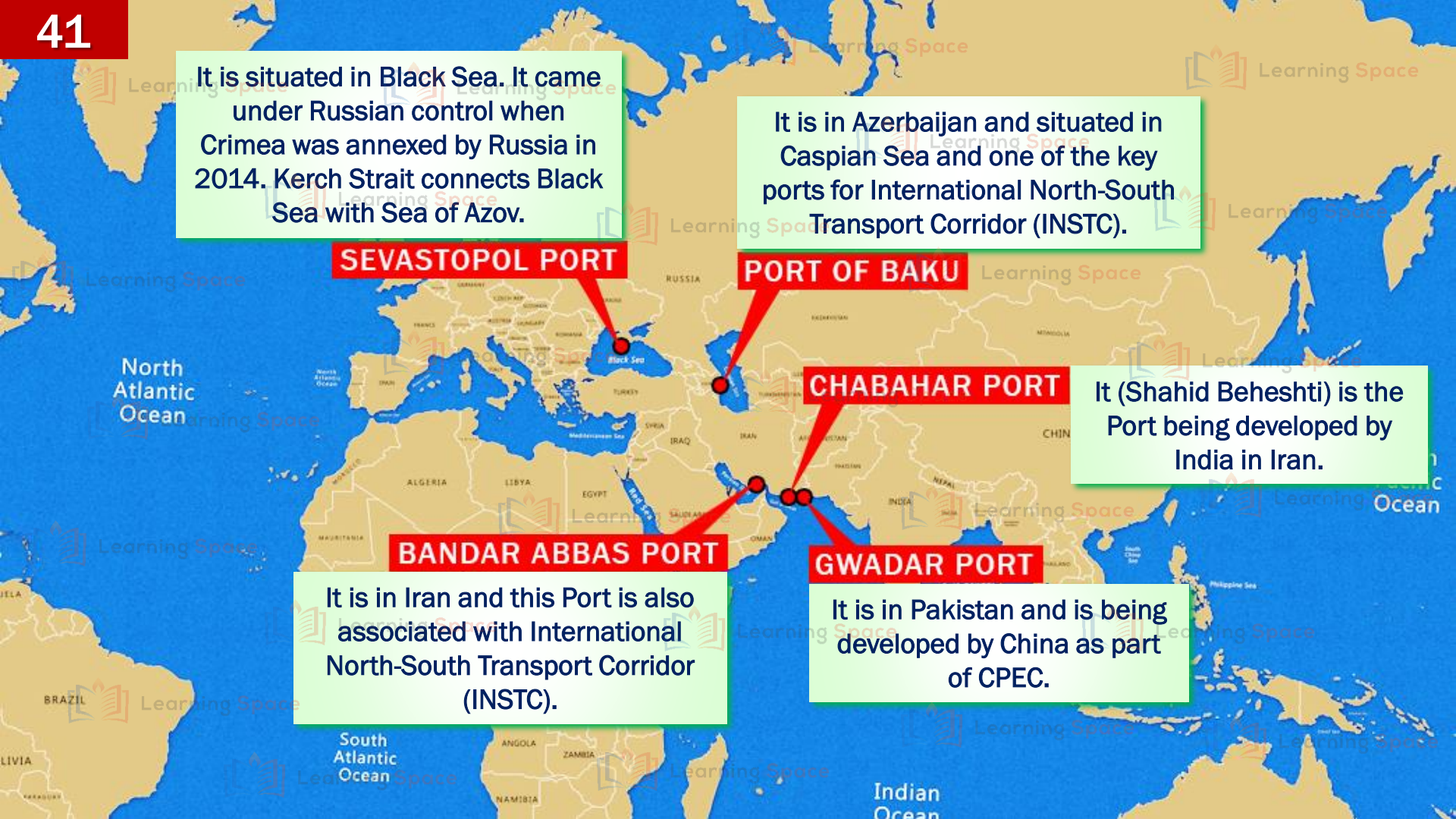
It (Shahid Beheshti) is the Port being developed by India in Iran.

BANDAR ABBAS PORT

It is in Iran and this Port is also associated with International North-South Transport Corridor (INSTC).

GWADAR PORT

It is in Pakistan and is being developed by China as part of CPEC.



TEN YEAR CONTRACT FOR CHABAHAH PORT WAS SIGNED BY INDIA AND IRAN



- Long-term agreement was signed between India Ports Global Limited (IPGL) and Port and Maritime Organization (PMO) of Iran, it enables operation of the Shahid-Behesti terminal for 10 years. IPGL will invest approximately \$120 million in equipping the port.
- India has also offered a credit window equivalent to \$250 million for mutually identified projects aimed at improving Chabahar-related infrastructure.

A Memorandum of Understanding for the development of the Chabahar port by India was signed in May 2015.



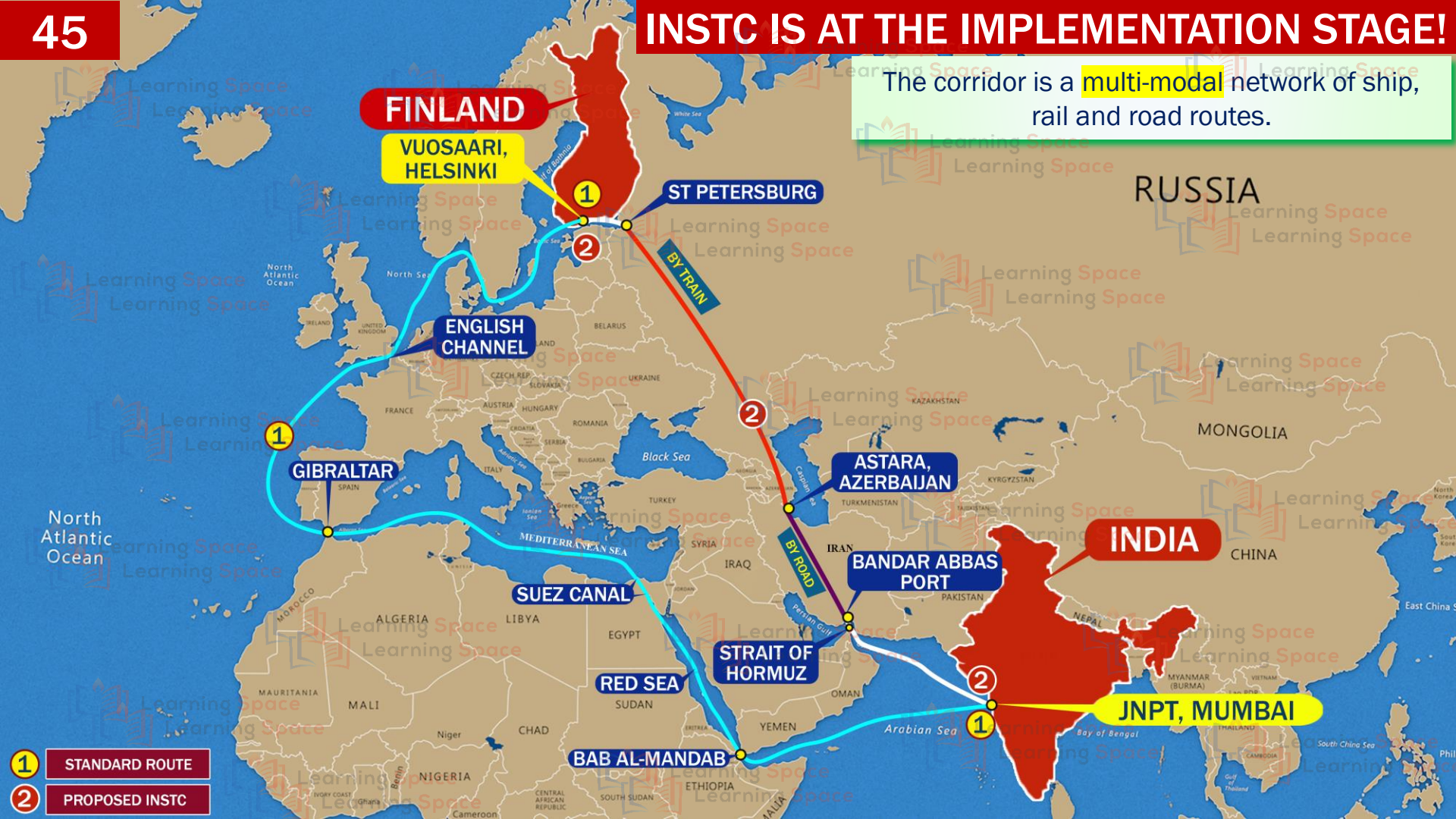
- 1 It is a deep-water port located in the Sistan-Baluchistan Province.
- 2 In 2016, a trilateral agreement to establish the International Transport and Transit Corridor (Chabahar Agreement) was signed by India, Iran and Afghanistan.
- 3 India is participating in the first phase of the Shahid Behesti terminal of the Chabahar port. The port is integrated with a special free zone.
- 4 IPGL, through its subsidiary, took the operations from December 24, 2018. Till now, a total of 2.5 million tonnes of wheat has been trans-shipped from India to Afghanistan.

Beyond commercial interests, the port is highly useful for humanitarian aid shipments.

CHENNAI - VLADIVOSTOK



The corridor is a **multi-modal** network of ship, rail and road routes.





WHAT DO YOU UNDERSTAND BY DELIMITATION?

- **Delimitation** means the **process** of **fixing** the **number** of **seats** and **boundaries** of **territorial constituencies** in each State for the Lok Sabha and Legislative Assemblies.
- It also includes **determining** the **seats** to be **reserved** for **SCs and STs** in these houses.
- Article 82 and 170 of the Constitution provide that the number of seats in the **Lok Sabha** and **State Legislative Assemblies** as well as its **division** into **territorial constituencies** shall be readjusted after each Census.
- The **delimitation process** is **performed** by the **Delimitation Commission** that is set up under an act of Parliament.
- Such an exercise was carried out after the 1951, 1961 and 1971 Census.
- The number of seats in the Lok Sabha based on the **1951, 1961 and 1971 Census** was **fixed** at **494, 522 and 543**, when the **population** was **36.1, 43.9 and 54.8 crore** respectively. This broadly translated to an average population of 7.3, 8.4 and 10.1 lakh per seat respectively.



- Number of seats have been frozen as per the 1971 Census in order to encourage population control measures so that States with higher population growth do not end up having higher number of seats.
- This was done through the 42nd Amendment Act till the year 2000 and was extended by the 84th Amendment Act till 2026.
- However, the boundaries of territorial constituencies were readjusted without changing the number of seats and seats for SC and ST were determined as per the 2001 Census.
- Hence, the population based on which the number of seats is allocated to each state refers to the population as per the 1971 Census. This number will be re-adjusted based on the first Census after 2026, which is now understood as 2027 Census.

PROVISIONS OF NEP, 1968

- NEP in 1968 advocated for Hindi to be a compulsory language across the nation.
- Hindi speaking states were required to teach Hindi, English and a modern Indian language – preferably a south Indian language – while non-Hindi speaking states were required to teach the local regional language, Hindi and English.



NEP, 2020 GAVE GREATER FLEXIBILITY

- NEP, 2020 technically not imposed any specific language on any state.
- It states that “the three languages learned by children will be the choices of States, regions, and, of course, the students themselves, so long as at least two of the three languages are native to India.”
- This means, in addition to the State’s language, children would be required to learn at least one other Indian language – not necessarily Hindi.
- The policy also emphasises bilingual teaching, particularly in the home language/mother tongue and English.

Conspicuously, it places significant emphasis on Sanskrit as an optional choice within the three-language formula.

In an affidavit filed in the Supreme Court in 2021, the Union Government has ruled out conducting a Socio-Economic Caste Census (SECC), stating that a caste census (except that for the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes done traditionally) was unfeasible, administratively difficult and cumbersome. Unlike in the case of the SCs and the STs, there is no constitutional mandate for the Registrar-General and Census Commissioner, India, to provide the census figures of the OBCs and others.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA DECIDED TO INCLUDE CASTE ENUMERATION IN THE NEXT CENSUS

- The Union Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided to include caste enumeration in the next census.
- This will be for the first time since Independence that caste data will be collected in the census, though the data for the SCs and STs is recorded.
- The broader caste data was last collected in the 1931 census.
- There is merit in collecting caste data and having information on other socio-economic aspects, because it could inform policy making. There are also strong counter-arguments.
- The census will be conducted in digital mode for the first time.
- The Census exercises before our independence starting from 1872 had a provision to collect information on caste, race and tribe.

46 LAKH DIFFERENT CASTES / SUB-CASTES AS PER 2011 SECC DATA!

- Socio Economic and Caste Census is a study of socio-economic status of rural and urban households that allows ranking of households based on predefined parameters, which was conducted in 2011.
- The **SECC-2011** data showed the presence of 46 lakh different castes. However, the Government not released the caste data of SECC, 2011.
- It is incidental to note that the total number of **castes** as per the last caste census of **1931** was **4,147**.

WHAT WAS THE PRIMARY REASON FOR LAKHS OF CASTES / SUB-CASTES?

- The flaws in the **data** stems primarily from the fact that no **registry of castes** was prepared before conducting **2011 caste census**.
- This resulted in mistakes by **enumerators**, who spelt the same caste in dozens of different ways.
- With no consistent way to **aggregate** or **segregate** same or similar castes with variant spellings, the number of caste categories ballooned.

As per latest government data, there are nearly 2,650 communities in the OBC Group, 1,170 in the SC category and 890 in the ST list in the Central List. The state governments maintain their own list of OBC groups. Census is in the Union List.

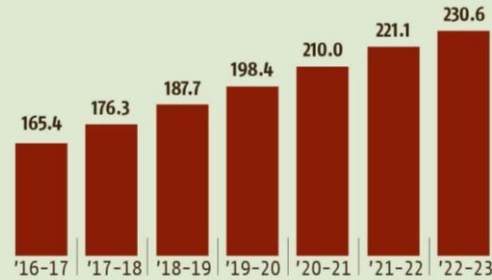
RIGHT TO EDUCATION ACT 2009



- 86th Constitution Amendment through Article 21(A) guarantees free and compulsory education for children aged 6 to 14 as a fundamental right.
- Right to Education Act, 2009 came into effect on April 1, 2010, and this ensures every child receives quality elementary education in a formal school that meets prescribed norms.
- New Education Policy (NEP), 2020 was approved by the Union Cabinet on July 29, 2020.
- Samagra Shiksha is for five years, ending March 31, 2026, for enhancing academic abilities across various student groups.
- National Initiative for Proficiency in Reading with Understanding and Numeracy (Nipun Bharat) aims to ensure that every child in the country achieves foundational literacy and numeracy by the end of grade three with a target completion by 2026-27.
- DIKSHA launched in 2017, aims at teacher training and professional development.
- SWAYAM Plus is to revolutionize higher education by implementing an innovative credit recognition system for industry relevant courses.

MILKY WAY

Milk production (million tonnes)

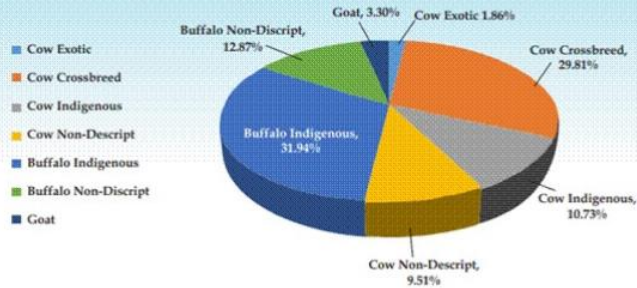


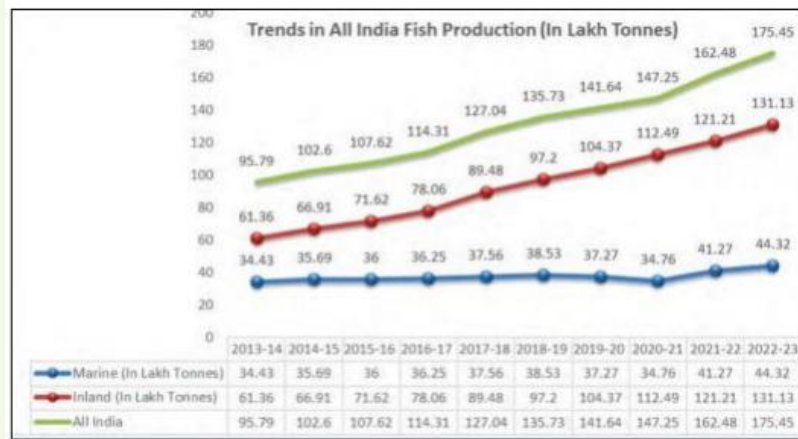
Source: NDDB and trade sources

- India is the world's largest producer of milk since 1998. The second largest producer is USA.
- At present, India contributes 25% of the global milk production. The total value of output of 231 million tonnes of milk in 2022-23 is Rs. 11.16 lakh crore.
- National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) was created in 1965.
- The first phase of operation flood was started in 1970. Verghese Kurien was the first chairman of NDDB.
- Total bovine population in 2019 is 30.22 crore, whereas the in-milk bovine population is 10.48 crore.

1.5.2.2 Percentage Share of Milk Production during 2022-23

Figure 1.4 : Species-Wise Milk Contribution In 2022-23





- India is the 3rd largest fish producer, 2nd largest aquaculture nation in the world after China and the largest producer of shrimp.
- Indian fisheries sector supports the livelihoods of around 30 million people, especially in coastal and rural communities.
- In recent years, Indian fisheries have experienced a significant shift, moving from a marine-dominated sector to a greater focus on inland fisheries.
- The contribution of inland fisheries to total fish production has risen dramatically in India. Within this shift, there has been a notable transition from capture fisheries to culture-based (or aquaculture) practices.

Inland fisheries contributes around 70% of the country's total fish production. The Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY), launched in May 2020, is a flagship initiative aimed at transforming India's Fisheries Sector.

What do you know about the recent report on the import of Pulses and Vegetable Oils?



- India's pulses and vegetable oil imports touch the record 7.3 million tons and 16.4 million tons valued at \$5.5 billion and \$17.3 billion respectively, in 2024-25.
- If one looks at the import of pulses - 2.6 million tonnes on an average during 2018-19 to 2022-23. They increased to 4.7 million tonnes and 7.3 million tons in the following two fiscals.
- Much of the increased domestic pulses production after 2015-16 is due to Chana and Moong Dal.
- As far as vegetable oil imports are concerned, they more than doubled from 7.9 million tonnes in 2013-14.

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